

The chair of Management of Digital Food Businesses, in cooperation with PLNT CORE is offering a

Project study

on the topic of

Make-vs-Buy Analysis for the Supply Chain of a Premium Microbiome Food Startup

PLNT CORE is an early-stage food startup developing the first natural premium microbiome paste based on real plants — a fermented microgreens paste enriched with diverse dietary fibres for daily consumption to support gut health. We are based in Bavaria and currently in the product development phase.

Scope of the project

Develop a make-vs-buy framework for PLNT CORE's supply chain, covering ingredient sourcing, production, packaging, and logistics. Students assess each value chain node against cost, quality, food safety, scalability, and strategic fit. Key questions: Which steps should stay in-house? Where do external partners offer clear advantages? Which microgreens suppliers in Bavaria/Germany are viable? What regulatory factors (HACCP, labelling) influence the decision? Deliverable: a decision framework and recommendation report.

Requirements

Strong analytical and structured thinking skills. Background in Food Science, Nutritional Science, Chemistry, Business/Operations, or Data Science is a plus but not required. No specific language requirements.

Start and duration: 1. July 2026, 3 months full-time

Language: English / German

Number of participants: 3–4

Supervisor TUM: Prof. Dr. Marjolein Buisman

Supervisors PLNT CORE: Timo Schlitz

Application

Please send a short motivation letter, your CV, and a current transcript of records to timo@pitchmarke.com.